HILCHOT SHABBAT

Lemons, Ice & Sugar Cubes: Squeezing on Shabbat

Given Thursday 28 May 2026 · Hilchot Shabbat Siman 320 Seifim 4-9 — מלאכת דש

Sefer: Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim **Siman:** 320 (שכ) **Topic:** מלאכת דש — Threshing & Squeezing (third shiur on this siman) **Tonight's seifim:** 4 (clarifications), 5 (boser), 6 (lemons), 7 (kvashim u'shlakot), 8 (fish), 9 (snow & ice)

Recap of the Last Two Shiurim

Foundational Concepts Established

Melacha of Dash (in the Mishkan) — extracting wheat kernels from their husks.

Toledah of Mifarek / Sechita — extracting liquid from a solid (e.g., olive oil, wine).

Three categories of fruit:

Category	Examples	Status
1 — Zeitim v'Anavim	Olives, grapes	Forbidden d'Oraita
2 — Tutim u'Rimonim	Berries, pomegranates, apples, oranges (commonly squeezed)	Forbidden d'Rabbanan
3	Fruits not normally squeezed	Permitted to squeeze

Gezeirat Mashkin Shezavu — liquid that flows on its own from Cat. 1 or Cat. 2 fruit is rabbinically forbidden (gezeira lest one come to squeeze).

Squeezing in the mouth (derech achilah) — permitted.

Pre-crushed olives/grapes — liquid that continues to ooze afterwards is permitted (covered last shiur, seifim 2-3).

The Foundation We Ended On (Seif 4 + Seif 7)

סוחט אדם אשכול ענבים לתוך קדרה אבל לא לתוך קערה *"A person may squeeze a cluster of grapes into a pot [containing food], but not into a [empty] bowl"*

The Gemara's principle:

משקה הבא לאוכל כאוכל דמי *"Liquid that comes [into] food has the status of food"*

Because the liquid is going directly onto a solid, we treat it as solid-from-solid (not a Dash violation).

Rabbeinu Chananel disagreed — held it's forbidden even onto food. **Everyone else (Rambam, Rosh, etc.) disagreed with him.** Lechatchila one is machmir for olives and grapes only (d'Oraita), but mei'ikar hadin even those are permitted.

PART 1 — Five Clarifications on Squeezing Onto Food

Several critical clarifications must be made on the *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel* principle.

Clarification 1 — Even Fruits Set Aside for Liquid

Even if the fruit was set aside *to be squeezed for juice* (*omeid l'mashkeh*) — bought before Shabbat with the intention to make juice after Shabbat — you may **still** squeeze it directly onto a solid on Shabbat.

The principle applies regardless of the owner's broader intention with the fruit.

Clarification 2 — Must Be DIRECTLY Onto the Solid

The whole heter is **only when squeezing goes directly from the fruit onto the food at the moment of extraction**.

What Is NOT Permitted

- Squeeze an orange into an empty cup
- Then pour from the cup onto a salad (even seconds later)
- **Even though** your intention from the start was to put it onto the salad

Everyone agrees this is forbidden.

The Reason

At the moment of *extraction*, the liquid is emerging into an empty space. That makes the action *liquid-from-solid* — exactly what Dash forbids. What you intend to do with the liquid afterwards doesn't change the status of the extraction itself.

D'Oraita or D'Rabbanan?

- For olives/grapes (Cat. 1): debated in Acharonim
- **Radbaz** held: since intention is for food, it's not d'Oraita
- **Either way:** assur — don't do it.

Clarification 3 — The Sugar Cube at the Bottom Trick

Chacham Ovadia warns against a common misunderstanding.

People hear the heter of *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel* and think: "I'll put a sugar cube at the bottom of my cup and squeeze 4-5 oranges over it — now I have orange juice and it's permissible because I squeezed onto a solid!"

This Does NOT Work

The heter has specific conditions. The liquid emerging onto the solid must be:

1. **Nivla** — absorbed into the solid, OR

2. **Metakken** — improving or enhancing the solid

Common-Sense Test

Action	Permitted?	Reason
Squeeze lemon onto fish	✅	Enhances the fish
Squeeze olives onto salad	✅	Adds to the salad
Squeeze a few drops onto a sugar cube for flavor	✅	Improving the sugar
Squeeze 4 oranges onto one sugar cube to make juice	❌	Not the heter — you're just squeezing into a cup

Use common sense. The amount must be reasonable — what the solid can absorb or be enhanced by.

Clarification 4 — Must Leave Edible Food Inside (Shulchan Aruch Harav / Ba'al HaTanya)

You cannot squeeze so thoroughly that nothing edible remains in the fruit.

The Logic

The whole heter is that you're treating the squeezed liquid as a *solid coming from a solid* — both edible.

If the fruit you're squeezing has nothing edible left:

- You're now extracting an "edible" (the liquid) from an inedible (the empty peel)
- That's the original Dash — extracting edible from inedible encasement
- The classic case from earlier hilchot: extracting peas from inedible pods is forbidden

Practical Implication

When squeezing a lemon, orange, or any fruit onto food on Shabbat, **don't squeeze it bone-dry**. Leave some pulp/flesh inside the peel.

Clarification 5 — Squeezing Onto Sugar to Then Add to Tea

What if I want to put lemon in my tea, but want to do it via this two-step approach?

1. Squeeze the lemon onto a sugar cube in a separate cup
2. Immediately pour the lemon-soaked sugar into the tea

Mishna Berura's Ruling: Permitted ✅

The Mishna Berura rules clearly that this is permitted, **even though** your full intention from the start is to pour it into a liquid.

Why

At the moment of *extraction*, the liquid is going onto a solid (the sugar cube). That's the operative moment for Dash. What happens afterwards (mixing with tea) is not the issue.

The Chazon Ish's Dissent

The Chazon Ish brought proofs to argue that **since your intention is to put it into a liquid, the lemon juice retains the status of liquid** — and therefore this should be forbidden.

The Halacha

Most Poskim disagree with the Chazon Ish.

- The Aruch HaShulchan rules permitted
- The mainstream halacha follows the Mishna Berura

Even if your intention is to immediately pour it into a liquid afterwards — at the time of extraction, it's onto a solid, and that is permitted.

Bottom Line on Squeezing Onto Food

You may squeeze any fruit directly onto food on Shabbat — salads, fish, sugar — and this is k'din (according to halacha) even with olives and grapes mei'ikar hadin. Those who want to be machmir like Rabbeinu Chananel only need to be careful with olives and grapes (d'Oraita).

PART 2 — Seif 7: Kvashim u'Shlakot (Pickles & Cooked Vegetables)

Definitions

- **Kvashim** — pickled items (cucumbers, pickles in brine)
- **Shlakot** — vegetables cooked with liquid (carrots in chicken soup)

The Rule

Purpose of Squeezing	Status
To improve the pickle/vegetable (get rid of excess soggy liquid)	✅ Permitted
To use/drink the liquid that comes out	❌ Forbidden

Rabbeinu Chananel?

Here we are **not machmir** for Rabbeinu Chananel because the issue is only d'Rabbanan.

Practical Applications

- Open pickle jar on Shabbat → pickles are too soggy → squeeze excess brine off ✅
- Carrots in your chicken soup are too soggy → squeeze them off ✅
- Saving the brine to drink as pickle juice → ❌ (though hard to imagine wanting to)

PART 3 — Seif 8: Squeezing Fish

One who squeezes a fish for its liquid has the same law as הסוחט דג לצירו דינו כסוחט כבשים ושלוקות *"one who squeezes pickles and cooked vegetables*

The same rule applies:

Purpose	Status
To improve the fish (get rid of excess oil/liquid)	✅ Permitted
To use the fish-liquid for something else	❌ Forbidden

Even though lots of liquid may come out — as long as the *purpose* is to make the fish more palatable, you may squeeze.

PART 4 — Seif 6: Lemons — The Shortest Seif, Most Debated Halacha

"It is permitted to squeeze lemons" מותר לסחוט לימונים

This three-word seif is one of the most heavily debated halachot in the entire Shulchan Aruch.

In the Beit Din, when testing dayanim on Shabbat halachot, this question of lemons consistently triggers an internal argument among the dayanim. The Dayanim deliberately stay away from this question.

The Source — Rabbeinu Asher (the Rosh)

The Rosh (Rabbeinu Asher), 700-800 years ago, wrote clearly that **it is mutar to squeeze lemons on Shabbat**.

His Reasoning

Lemons are **Category 3** (fruits not commonly squeezed for their juice).

- Category 1: olives and grapes (d'Oraita)
- Category 2: berries, pomegranates, apples, oranges (commonly squeezed for juice you drink alone)
- **Category 3:** fruits not normally squeezed for standalone juice — and lemons fit here

500 years ago (and arguably today), people did not squeeze lemons to drink lemon juice alone. Lemon juice was always used with something else — water, sugar, food.

The Beit Yosef's Question

Rabbi Yosef Karo, living in Egypt while writing the Shulchan Aruch, observed something striking:

"In Egypt, I see everyone squeezes lemon — they squeeze lemons onto water with sugar inside to make lemonade. They put sugar in their cups, then squeeze the lemons in. And לא ראינו מי שפקפק בדבר *— I have never seen anyone who questioned this practice on Shabbat."*

The Apparent Contradiction

The Rosh said lemons are permitted because *people don't squeeze them for juice*. But the Beit Yosef is seeing the opposite — everyone IS squeezing them, in significant quantities, to make lemonade.

Important Note: It's Not the *Meshakeh Ha'ba El Ha'ochel* Heter

You might think: maybe the Beit Yosef thought this works because you're squeezing onto sugar (a solid). But this can't be the explanation, because:

- A reasonable amount onto a sugar cube — yes, that would be *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel*
- But filling up cups of lemonade — that's far more than a sugar cube can absorb or be enhanced by

So why are the people in Egypt doing it freely on Shabbat? The Beit Yosef gives **two answers**.

The Beit Yosef's Answer 1 — Lemons Are Never Drunk Alone

The Chachamim only gave a status of liquid (Category 2) to fruits whose juice is **valued as a standalone drink**.

Fruit	Drink Alone?	Category
Pomegranate	✅ People drink pomegranate juice	Cat. 2
Apple, orange	✅ People drink apple/orange juice	Cat. 2
Strawberries, berries	✅ Berry juice	Cat. 2
Lemon	❌ **No one drinks lemon juice alone**	**Cat. 3**

The whole reason the Chachamim gave a status of liquid to Category 2 fruits is because people *machshiv* (give importance to) the juice as a drink in its own right. Since no one drinks lemon juice alone — it's always added to something — the Chachamim never gave it the status of liquid. **It permanently stays Category 3.**

The Beit Yosef's Answer 2 — They're Squeezing It Into Something Else

A subtly different reason: because they're squeezing the lemon directly *into* water with sugar (not alone), this shows the lemon juice doesn't have a standalone status.

The heter, according to this reason, is **specific to the act**: you're squeezing into something else (the sugar water).

The Critical Nafka Mina Between the Two Answers

Can I squeeze many lemons on Shabbat afternoon into a jug alone — nothing else — and then add water and sugar later in the day?

(Example: hot summer day, 60 kids coming over, want to make lemonade in advance.)

According to Answer 1 (Beit Yosef)

✅ **Permitted.** Lemons are never drunk alone — their status as Category 3 doesn't depend on what you mix them with at the moment. They are permanently Category 3.

According to Answer 2 (Beit Yosef)

❌ **Forbidden.** The heter only works when squeezing directly into something else. Squeezing alone into a jug — even with intent to add water/sugar later — doesn't get the heter.

What Does the Shulchan Aruch Actually Rule?

He writes simply: **"מותר לסחוט לימונים"** — without specifying which reason.

What's Clearly Permitted (Both Reasons Agree)

Squeezing lemons directly into tea — Permitted according to **both** Beit Yosef answers.

This is the clear simple reading of the Shulchan Aruch.

What's Debated

Squeezing lemons into an empty cup with intent to add water/sugar later — permitted per Answer 1, forbidden per Answer 2.

The Mishna Berura's Stringent Position

The Mishna Berura wrote that **times have changed**:

בזמן הזה שידוע שממלאים חבית למאות לשתות עם פאנץ' באיזה מקומות, צריך עיון גדול אם מותר לסחטן בשבת לתוך משקה, דאפשר דדמי לתותים ורימונים דנעשו משקין בפני עצמן

Nowadays it's known that they fill barrels of lemon juice in some places to drink as a kind of punch — it requires great consideration whether it is permitted to squeeze them on Shabbat into liquid, because perhaps it now resembles berries and pomegranates which are made into standalone drinks.

His Ruling

ועל כן צריך להיזהר שיסחט מקודם על הסוכר בפני עצמו דהוה כמשקה הבא לאוכל

Therefore one must be careful to squeeze first onto sugar by itself — using the *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel* heter (with a reasonable amount onto the sugar).

Why the Mishna Berura Diverges from Both Beit Yosef Answers

- **Answer 1** would still permit (lemons still not drunk alone)
- **Answer 2** would forbid (since the derech is now to make standalone lemon juice)

The Mishna Berura takes Answer 2 — that the *current* practice determines the status. Since now there's a lemon juice industry, Answer 2 fails, and the heter falls.

This is why Ashkenazim do NOT squeeze lemons directly into tea on Shabbat. They follow the Mishna Berura.

The Ben Ish Chai's Position — Also Machmir

The Ben Ish Chai is machmir, ruling like the Mishna Berura that lemons should be squeezed onto a solid first.

His Beautiful Mnemonic

Based on Yaakov's vision of the ladder:

סולם מוצב ארצה *"A ladder set on the ground"*

The word **סולם** is rashei teivot:

ס = **ס**וכר (Sukar — sugar)
ל = **ל**ימון (Limon — lemon)
מ = **מ**ים (Mayim — water)

The Practical Lemonade Method (Following the Sulam Order)

1. **Sugar** first in the bowl/cup
2. **Lemon** squeezed onto the sugar
3. **Water** added last

Never: put the water first and then squeeze lemons in.

Chacham Ovadia's Lenient Position

Chacham Ovadia rules **like Answer 1 of the Beit Yosef**:

- Lemons are never drunk alone (still true even today — commercial "lemon juice" is for cooking/mixing, not standalone drinking)
- Therefore lemons remain Category 3
- The first reason of the Beit Yosef is logical and applies even now
- **One may squeeze lemons even into an empty cup on Shabbat** and add water/sugar later
- One may squeeze lemons directly into tea

Chacham Ben Tzion Abba Shaul also ruled leniently.

Practical Sephardi Ruling

- The simple reading of the Shulchan Aruch supports the lenient position
- Since it's a Rabbinic safek, one can be lenient
- One may squeeze lemons directly into tea
- One may even squeeze into an empty cup and use later (though the sulam method is also fine)

Mark's Question — Pour Lemon Into Water, or Water Into Lemon?

If you have sugar water and squeezed lemon separately, is there a difference between which way you pour them together?

According to Answer 1 (Beit Yosef)

No difference. Lemons are permanently not classified as liquid because they're never drunk alone. Direction of pouring is irrelevant.

According to Answer 2 (Beit Yosef)

Yes, there IS a difference. The heter is specifically that you're squeezing the lemon *into* something else. So you'd need to squeeze the lemon **into water** (not water into the lemon).

Bottom Line

Since this is a safek d'Rabbanan and the Beit Yosef explicitly testifies *"I have never seen anyone who questioned"* the practice, one can be lenient — particularly per Answer 1.

Chacham Ovadia's Important Caveat — Kalei HaBishul

When squeezing lemon into tea, **do not squeeze into a kli rishon** (the original kettle from the fire).

Squeeze into a **kli sheni** (a cup that has been poured from the kettle) — because lemons are *kalei habishul* (easily cooked), and bishul could be an issue in a kli rishon.

The Borer Concern

There could also be a **borer issue** when squeezing lemons:

- You're separating the desirable juice from the undesirable pulp/seeds

The Resolution

- Apply the principle of **guf echad** (one body) — something coming naturally from one body is not Borer
- This heter works **lechatchila only samuch l'seudah** (close to consumption)

Practical Implication

Squeezing lemons should be done **close to when the juice will be used** — not hours in advance. (This is one reason many people squeeze lemons before Shabbat.)

PART 5 — Seif 5: Unripe Grapes (Boser)

יש מי שאומר דהוא הדין לבוסר שמותר לסחוט אותו לתוך האוכל, ורבינו תם אוסר בבוסר שאינו ראוי לאכילה

The Machloket Rishonim

Rabbeinu Yosef: Just as you may squeeze ripe grapes onto food (*meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel*), you may also squeeze unripe grapes (*boser*) onto food.

Rabbeinu Tam: Forbidden. The heter only works when the fruit is itself edible. Unripe grapes are inedible.

Rabbeinu Tam's Reasoning — Two Explanations in the Acharonim

Explanation 1 — Borer

You're separating something edible (the juice) from something inedible (the unripe pulp). This is borer. *(If this is the reason, samuch l'seudah would be permitted.)*

Explanation 2 — Dash (the main reason)

The heter of *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel* depends on the squeezing being from edible to edible. Since boser is inedible:

- You're extracting an "edible" (the juice) from an "inedible" (the unripe pulp/peel)
- That's the classic Dash — like the example earlier about edible food in an inedible pod

This is exactly the same logic as Clarification 4 above (Shulchan Aruch Harav's point about leaving edible fruit inside).

How the Shulchan Aruch Rules

He brings the first opinion as ***"yesh mi she'omer"*** (anonymous "some say") and then brings **Rabbeinu Tam by name**.

Sha'ar HaTziyun's Rule (Mishna Berura)

"When the Shulchan Aruch brings the first opinion anonymously and then brings a Rishon by name as the second opinion — follow the named opinion."

Therefore, halacha follows Rabbeinu Tam: unripe grapes (boser) may NOT be squeezed onto food on Shabbat.

Chacham Ovadia Rules the Same Way

Chacham Ovadia agrees mei'ikar hadin that Shulchan Aruch follows Rabbeinu Tam.

Chacham Ovadia's Three-Fold Leniency for Immediate Use

However, Chacham Ovadia permits squeezing boser onto food **samuch l'seudah** (immediately for use). His reasoning combines three considerations:

Reason 1

There is still Rabbeinu Yosef as a senior Rishon who permits — we don't follow him, but his opinion is part of the safek.

Reason 2

Maybe Rabbeinu Tam's reason is **Borer** (Explanation 1) — and we know samuch l'seudah is permitted for Borer.

Reason 3 (Most Innovative)

Even if Rabbeinu Tam's reason is **Dash** (Explanation 2):

- Most Rishonim hold that the heter of *samuch l'seudah* applies only to **Borer**, not Dash

- **Why?** Dash is a more "industrial" melacha — done en masse in the fields, threshing wheat. Borer is more personal.
- **But the Rashba** held that just as samuch l'seudah is permitted for Borer, it's also permitted for Dash

Combining all three svarot together — Chacham Ovadia rules that boser may be squeezed onto food on Shabbat **only if for immediate use**.

Practical Ruling

- Squeezing boser onto a salad samuch l'seudah → ✅ Permitted (Chacham Ovadia)
- Squeezing boser hours in advance → ❌ Forbidden

PART 6 — Wrapping Up Part 1 of Siman 320

This completes the **Toledah of Mefarek/Sechita** — the d'Oraita and d'Rabbanan laws of squeezing fruit on Shabbat.

Summary of Squeezing (Seifim 1-8)

- Three categories of fruit
- Gezeirat mashkin shezavu
- Squeezing in the mouth (derech achilah)
- Pre-crushed olives/grapes
- The principle of *meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel*
- The five clarifications on this principle
- Kvashim u'shlakot
- Fish
- **Lemons** — the famous debate
- Unripe grapes (boser)

PART 7 — Beginning Part 2 of Siman 320: Snow and Ice (Seif 9)

We now turn to the **rabbinic prohibitions** related to Dash. This second section runs from **Seif 9 through Seif 14**, then concludes with material related to **Melaben** and a critical principle at the end of the chapter.

The Gemara (Shabbat 51)

אין מרסקין לא את השלג ולא את הברד בשבת בשביל שיזובו מימיהן. אבל נותן הוא לתוך הכוס או לתוך הקערה ואינו חושש

One may not crush snow or hail on Shabbat to extract liquid from them. But one may place them into a cup or bowl, and there is no concern.

Why Would Crushing Snow Be Forbidden?

You have snow, you bring it inside, you crush it to make ice water. Why is this rabbinically forbidden?

There are **three explanations** in the Rishonim — all agreeing this is **d'Rabbanan**, but differing on the underlying reason.

Reason 1 — Rashi: Similar to Makeh BePatish

משום דקא מוליד בשבת ודמי למלאכה שבורא המים האלו

Because you are *creating* something — and this resembles the melacha that brings these waters into being.

You're creating something new — solid becoming liquid. This is similar to *makeh bepatish* (the final blow that completes a creation).

Clearly only rabbinic — you're not literally creating something out of nothing, just changing form. But the *appearance* of creating something new makes it forbidden d'Rabbanan.

Reason 2 — Rambam: Similar to Dash

The Rambam places this halacha in his discussion of Dash. His reasoning:

When you squeeze fruit, you extract liquid from a solid. Here too, you're extracting liquid from a solid (snow → water). Rabbinically forbidden because of its **similarity to the Toledah of Sechita** under Dash.

The fact that the Shulchan Aruch places this halacha within Siman 320 (Dash) strongly suggests he follows the Rambam's understanding.

Reason 3 — Rabbeinu Baruch of Mainz (Ba'al HaTerumah): Nolad

A third, minority opinion (which we saw briefly in Hilchot Bishul). The Ba'al HaTerumah held it's a form of **nolad** (newly-created on Shabbat) — like an apple that fell from a tree on Shabbat is muktzeh.

Something genuinely new is being created — a kind of muktzeh issue.

Critical Implication of the Third Opinion

Even allowing solid → liquid to happen *on its own* would be a problem, because the prohibition focuses on the *creation* of the new, not the action.

The Three Reasons Compared

Reason	Author	Focus	Allows passive melting?
Makeh bePatish	Rashi	The crushing action creating something new	✅ Yes
Dash	Rambam	Extracting liquid from solid	✅ Yes
Nolad	Ba'al HaTerumah	The creation itself	❌ No

Practical Question 1: Can I Take Ice Cubes Out to Melt on Their Own?

You have a tray of ice cubes from before Shabbat. Can you take them out and leave them on the counter to melt on their own?

Per Rashi and Rambam

✅ **Permitted.** The Gemara forbade *crushing* (an action). Passive melting is not crushing — and the Shulchan Aruch (following these reasons) clearly permits.

Per Ba'al HaTerumah

❌ **Forbidden.** Even melting on its own creates something new.

What Does the Shulchan Aruch Rule?

וכן אם הניחם בחמה או כנגד המדורה והושרו — מותרין

One may leave snow/ice in the sun or near a heater and they may melt on their own — permitted.

The Shulchan Aruch clearly does NOT follow the Ba'al HaTerumah.

The Rema's Position

In **Hilchot Bishul (Siman 318)**, the Rema discussed the case of an empanada (meat pastry with congealed fat) being placed near the fire. The fat melts and becomes gravy.

The Rema cited that **yesh machmirim** (some are stringent) following the Ba'al HaTerumah:

ונהגו להחמיר ובמקום צורך יש להקל

The custom is to be stringent, but in case of need one may be lenient.

Practical Ruling

- **Sephardim:** Follow Shulchan Aruch — ✅ may take ice cubes out and leave them to melt
- **Ashkenazim:** Lechatchila avoid; b'di'avad / in case of need (extreme heat, baby needs milk, frozen wine for Shabbat, etc.) — permitted

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Practical Question 2: Can I Put Ice Cubes Into a Drink?

This is **universally permitted** — agreed by all three reasons.

Why All Three Agree

Reason	Why putting in liquid is permitted
Rashi (makeh bepatish)	You can't *see* the new water being created — it's hidden in the existing liquid
Rambam (dash)	The new "liquid" immediately merges with existing liquid — not standalone extraction
Ba'al HaTerumah (nolad)	The new liquid never has independent existence

The Shulchan Aruch (Seif 9)

השלג והברד אין מרסקין אותם — דהיינו לשברם חתיכות דקות כדי שיזובו מימיהן. אבל נותן לתוך הכוס של יין או מים, והוא נימוח מאליו ואינו חושש

Snow and hail may not be crushed (broken into thin pieces to extract their liquid). But one may place them into a cup of wine or water, and they melt on their own, without concern.

Practical Question 3: Can I Crush Ice Cubes Already in My Drink?

You go to a function, they give you a drink with three-quarters ice cubes and only a quarter of actual drink. You want to crush the ice with your spoon to speed up the melting. May you?

According to the Ba'al HaTerumah

✅ **Permitted** — the prohibition is on creating something new with independent existence; here it's immediately mixed in.

According to Rashi/Rambam — A Machloket Acharonim

One side (more stringent):

- The Gemara forbade *crushing* — that's an action
- The Gemara permitted only *passive* melting in liquid
- Therefore active crushing remains forbidden

Other side (Magen Avraham, Mishna Berura mei'ikar hadin):

- The whole prohibition was about *seeing* the new water created
- When in liquid, you don't see anything new being created
- Therefore even active crushing is permitted

Shulchan Aruch's Wording

נותנו לתוך הכוס והוא נימוח מאליו ואינו חושש

"One may place it in the cup AND IT MELTS ON ITS OWN, and there is no concern."

The phrase **"melts on its own"** (נימוח מאליו) suggests the heter is only for passive melting, not active crushing.

Halacha

- **Mishna Berura:** Mei'ikar hadin permitted, but cites the strict view
- **Ben Ish Chai: Forbidden** — because the simple reading of Shulchan Aruch (Maran) implies forbidden
- **Chacham Ovadia:** Forbidden — follows Shulchan Aruch's apparent stringency

Practical Bottom Line

- **Sephardim:** Do NOT crush ice cubes in your drink with a spoon or fork on Shabbat
- **Ashkenazim:** Mei'ikar hadin permitted (Mishna Berura), but better to refrain

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The Ben Ish Chai's Key Distinction — Sugar Is Different

סוכר שקורין קנדי שמתקנים באירופא... מותר לרסקו בתוך המים למתקו בהם

Sugar (called "candy" — from the Arabic *kand*, which is where the English word "candy" comes from) that is made in Europe — it is permitted to crush it in water to sweeten the water.

The Logic — A Major Distinction

יש חילוק גדול בין סוכר ובין שלג וברד

There is a great distinction between sugar and snow/hail.

Substance	Nature of "crushing in liquid"
Ice cubes	**Transformation** — solid water becomes liquid water (change of form)
Sugar cubes	**Dissolution** — sugar disperses in water but remains sugar

The Proof for Sugar

Evaporate the water — and the sugar will return at the bottom.

The sugar is simply dispersing into the water, not changing its essential nature. So even Maran (Shulchan Aruch), who would forbid crushing ice in water, would **agree** that sugar cubes may be crushed in tea.

Practical Application

✅ You may use your spoon to dissolve a sugar cube in your tea on Shabbat (Sephardim and Ashkenazim alike). ❌ You may not use your spoon to crush ice cubes in your soda (Sephardim per Ben Ish Chai and Chacham Ovadia).

A Final Important Note

All of these prohibitions only apply when one is crushing or melting to make liquid (or a significant quantity of liquid).

A few drops of incidental melting is not a concern.

Complete Summary Table

Squeezing Fruit (Seifim 1-8)

Action	Status
Squeeze fruit directly onto food (meshakeh ha'ba el ha'ochel)	✅ Permitted (be machmir with olives/grapes)
Squeeze fruit into empty cup, even with intent to add to food	❌ Forbidden
Squeeze fruit so dry that nothing edible remains	❌ Forbidden
Squeeze a few drops onto a small solid like sugar (reasonable amount)	✅ Permitted
Squeeze multiple oranges onto one sugar cube to "make juice"	❌ Not the heter
Squeeze fruit onto sugar, then pour into liquid	✅ Permitted (Mishna Berura)
Squeeze kvashim/shlakot to discard excess liquid	✅ Permitted
Squeeze kvashim/shlakot to use the liquid	❌ Forbidden
Squeeze fish for the fish itself (excess liquid)	✅ Permitted
Squeeze lemons via the **sulam method** (sugar → lemon → water)	✅ Universally permitted
Squeeze lemons directly into tea	✅ Sephardim per Shulchan Aruch / ❌ Ashkenazim per Mishna Berura
Squeeze lemons into empty cup for later use	✅ Chacham Ovadia / debated
Squeeze lemons into kli rishon (the kettle itself)	❌ Forbidden (kalei habishul)
Squeeze boser (unripe grapes) for immediate use samuch l'seudah	✅ Per Chacham Ovadia
Squeeze boser in advance	❌ Forbidden

Snow & Ice (Seif 9)

Action	Sephardim	Ashkenazim
Take ice cubes out of freezer to melt on their own	✅ Permitted	Lechatchila avoid; b'di'avad permitted
Put ice cubes in a drink	✅ Permitted	✅ Permitted
Actively crush ice cubes in a drink with spoon	❌ Don't do it	Mei'ikar hadin permitted, better not
Crush sugar cube in tea (Ben Ish Chai's distinction)	✅ Permitted	✅ Permitted
Crush snow/hail to extract water (active crushing)	❌ Forbidden	❌ Forbidden

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Coming Up Next Week

- **Walking on snow** on Shabbat
- The major and important discussion of **washing hands with a bar of soap** on Shabbat

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Shabbat Shalom

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